March 2026

The Honorable Marco Rubio
Secretary of State
U.S. Department of State
2201 C Street NW
Washington, DC 20520

Dear Secretary Rubio,

You have spoken with more clarity than almost any figure in American public life about what American exceptionalism actually means — not a birthright, but an ongoing achievement. A republic that must be earned by each generation. That is the exact argument of the National Experiential Civic Education Framework.

The Founders framed America as a long experiment in democratic self-government — a wager that free citizens, properly educated and engaged, could govern themselves. Hamilton and Madison understood that no constitution could substitute for civic virtue in the citizenry. That virtue is now in measurable decline, and NECEF is a concrete, bipartisan structural response.

The framework proposes hands-on civic programs in schools: community service, emergency preparedness, infrastructure stewardship, and leadership development. It builds on existing federal programs — AmeriCorps, FEMA CERT, Title IV — without creating new bureaucracy. States and localities define their own programs. The cost is $57-$87 per student annually. The outcome data from existing precedent programs is strong.

Your voice on this — framed as a national security and American renewal issue — would reach audiences that no other advocate can reach. I am asking you to review the enclosed white paper and consider lending your public support to this effort.

With great respect,

Gina Aulabaugh